Nicolas Wajs | Head of Financial Systems Engineering

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Product and delivery leader with 20+ years building and assessing mission-critical software for regulated financial institutions (Finastra, Misys, Opensee, Thomson Reuters), and now running a fully AI-assisted delivery practice as an independent consultant. I have owned a data pipeline end to end in production (ETL ingestion, reconciliation, pre-ingestion controls, metadata management, data-quality reporting), led vendor/system assessments and RFP responses for 30+ financial institutions, and architected a multi-agent AI copilot with governance by design. My domain depth is markets/risk technology (Sophis, FusionRisk) rather than corporate-finance ERP or treasury tooling I name that directly rather than overstate it but the underlying skillset the role calls for (data architecture, system assessment, AI-native delivery, cross-functional program leadership in regulated, multicountry environments) transfers directly and I learn new domains fast: PRM certified, AI for Business certified (Ecole Polytechnique X-EXED), MSc in Data Management & Financial Modeling (ENSIIE).

Core Competencies

- **Data Architecture & Pipeline Ownership**: Owned an ETL ingestion pipeline end to end (data reconciliation, pre-ingestion controls, metadata management) for a real-time analytics platform; prototyped with OpenMetadata, industrialized with Apache NiFi; built the first data-quality reporting and anomaly-escalation process with a Tier-1 client
- **AI-Native Delivery & Automation**: Ran a fully AI-assisted development lifecycle with Claude Code (Angular, .NET, SQL Server), 0 to production in under 2 months; architected a multi-agent copilot (Python, CrewAI, Dataiku) with GDPR/EU AI Act governance by design
- **Finance-Technology Assessment & Vendor Positioning**: 20+ years assessing, positioning, and defending build-vs-buy decisions on front-to-back trading and risk platforms (Sophis, FusionRisk) for 30+ buy-side and sell-side institutions; led RFP/RFI responses and competitive-bid coordination
- **Regulated, Multicountry Program Leadership**: Delivered ISO 27001 and SOC 2 requirements for a first enterprise SaaS deployment in a bank environment; mentored and scaled consulting/support teams across Europe (30) and Asia (Beijing, Manila); coordinated 25+ consultants across multicountry delivery programs
- **Financial-Markets Domain Fluency**: Professional Risk Manager (PRM) certified — market risk, financial instruments, counterparty and operational risk; Executive Master's, Corporate Finance & Capital Markets (IHFi)
- **Stakeholder & Executive Reporting**: Weekly KPI reporting to CTO; guaranteed 95% uptime, delivered 99%+ in first 6 months of production; cross-functional coordination with DevOps, security, and business stakeholders on compliance-critical deliveries

Professional Experience

- **WANIC & Associates** — **Paris, France**
  Data & AI Product Lead — *Jul 2025-Present*
  - Architected and prototyped a multi-agent copilot (Python, CrewAI, Dataiku) for manager onboarding, 360 reviews, and disengagement detection, designing tool use, orchestration patterns, and acceptance criteria, with GDPR/EU AI Act governance by design
  - AI Delivery Lead on a broker and data-provider evaluation application for a French asset manager (Angular, .NET, SQL Server): fully AI-assisted development lifecycle with Claude Code, delivered in under 2 months
  - Led the go-live of a credit-structuring data platform (Angular, C#, Dataflow, Power BI, SQL Server) for a leading European investment bank, end of 2025, coordinating delivery through production
  - Designed and delivered an AI recruitment solution: automated CV parsing and candidate/job-description match scoring, defining evaluation criteria for model output quality

- **Opensee** — **Paris, France**
  Product Manager - SaaS & Customer Success — *Oct 2022-Apr 2025*
  - Owned the ETL ingestion pipeline (data reconciliation, pre-ingestion controls, metadata management) for a real-time analytics platform; prototyped flows with OpenMetadata, industrialized with Apache NiFi
  - Built the first data-quality reporting and anomaly-escalation process with a Tier-1 global asset manager through the platform's first production go-live: 99% availability against a 95% contractual target over the first 6 months, with weekly KPI reporting to the CTO
  - Delivered ISO 27001 and SOC 2 requirements for the company's first SaaS deployment with DevOps, aligned to bank technical constraints
- **Finastra** — **Customer Experience**
  Principal Product Advisor Sophis - EMEA & Americas — *Sep 2017-Oct 2022*
  - Assessed and positioned front-to-back trading and risk platforms (Sophis, FusionRisk) against evolving regulatory needs for 30+ financial institutions; ran strategic usage-audit workshops across 5 countries generating +65% qualified sales opportunities
  - Coordinated RFP responses and product positioning in competitive bids; supervised presales engagements across 12 consultants, supporting $500K-$3M upsell and renewal deals
- **Misys** — **Customer Services**
  Lead Account Manager & Sophis Expert - Continental Europe — *Aug 2013-Jun 2017*
  - Technical account management for 15+ buy-side and sell-side institutions; mentored offshore consulting teams across Europe (30) and Asia (5 Beijing, 10 Manila)
- **Sophis SAS** — **Professional Services**
  Consulting Project Manager - Continental Europe — *Jul 2011-Jul 2013*
  - Delivered 2 implementation and 5 upgrade projects across Europe (portfolio management, front-to-back, risk, compliance); coordinated 25+ consultants; chaired project reviews and Steering Committees
- **Thomson Reuters** — **R&D, Paris**
  Product & Solution Manager — *Oct 2007-May 2011*
  - Scoped Reuters Trader and Eikon enhancements with 4+ business verticals; coordinated development, QA, and 3rd-level support delivering 30-60 software updates annually
- **Reuters** — **Client Services, Paris**
  Product Quality & 3rd-Level Support Lead — *Sep 2002-Sep 2007*
  - Managed a team of 10+ consultants and mentored 20+ in Bangkok; led functional QA coordinating 80+ FTEs on analytics and financial-models library validation

Education

- **Ecole Polytechnique (X-EXED)** — **Paris, France**
  Certificate, AI for Business — *2025-2026*
  Artificial Intelligence and Data Management Solution Engineering.
- **Institut de Haute Finance (IHFi 41)** — **Paris, France**
  Executive Master's, Corporate Finance & Capital Markets — *2010-2012*
- **ENSIIE (formerly IIE-CNAM)** — **Evry, France**
  MSc, Data Management & Financial Modeling — *1999-2002*
  High Distinction in Economics

Certifications

- **Professional Risk Manager (PRM)** – PRMIA, 2019.
- **Product & AI** (2025): Aha! PM Professional; Dataiku GenAI Practitioner & Core Designer; LangChain/RAG & CrewAI (DeepLearning.AI).

Languages

- French (native), English (fluent, spoken and written professionally), German (intermediate).